

1. Codex CLI 0.128.0 adds /goal

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-04-30T23:23:17+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Apr/30/codex-goals/#atom-everything>

Codex CLI 0.128.0 adds /goal The latest version of OpenAI's Codex CLI coding agent adds their own version of the Ralph loop : you can now set a /goal and Codex will keep on looping until it evaluates that the goal has been completed... or the configured token budget has been exhausted. It looks like the feature is mainly implemented through the goals/continuation.md and goals/budget_limit.md prompts, which are automatically injected at the end of a turn. Via @fcoury Tags: ai , openai , prompt-engineering , generative-ai , llms , coding-agents , system-prompts , codex-cli , agentic-engineering

2. Our evaluation of OpenAI's GPT-5.5 cyber capabilities

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-04-30T23:03:24+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Apr/30/gpt-55-cyber-capabilities/#atom-everything>

Our evaluation of OpenAI's GPT-5.5 cyber capabilities The UK's AI Security Institute previously evaluated Claude Mythos : now they've evaluated GPT-5.5 for finding security vulnerability and found it to be comparable to Mythos, but unlike Mythos it's generally available right now.

Tags: ai , openai , generative-ai , llms , anthropic , claude , ai-security-research , gpt

3. Quoting Andrew Kelley

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-04-30T21:24:55+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Apr/30/andrew-kelley/#atom-everything>

It's a common misconception that we can't tell who is using LLM and who is not. I'm sure we didn't catch 100% of LLM-assisted PRs over the past few months, but the kind of mistakes humans make are fundamentally different than LLM hallucinations, making them easy to spot. Furthermore, people who come from the world of agentic coding have a certain digital smell that is not obvious to them but is obvious to those who abstain. It's like when a smoker walks into the room, everybody who doesn't smoke instantly knows it. I'm not telling you not to smoke, but I am telling you not to smoke in my house. ? Andrew Kelley , Creator of Zig Tags: zig , llms , ai , generative-ai

4. Anti-DDoS Firm Heaped Attacks on Brazilian ISPs

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 14:04:26 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/04/anti-ddos-firm-heaped-attacks-on-brazilian-isps/>

A Brazilian tech firm that specializes in protecting networks from distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attacks has been enabling a botnet responsible for an extended campaign of massive DDoS attacks against other network operators in Brazil, KrebsOnSecurity has learned. The firm's chief executive says the malicious activity resulted from a security breach and was likely the work of a competitor trying to tarnish his company's public image.

5. Apple Q2 2026 Results

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-01T00:41:20Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/04/apple-reports-second-quarter-results/>

Apple Newsroom: ?Today Apple is proud to report our best March quarter ever, with revenue of \$111.2 billion and double-digit growth across every geographic segment,? said Tim Cook, Apple?s CEO. ?iPhone achieved a March quarter revenue record, fueled by such extraordinary demand for the iPhone 17 lineup. During the quarter, Services achieved yet another all-time record, and we were excited to introduce remarkable new products to our strongest lineup ever. That included the addition of the iPhone 17e and the M4-powered iPad Air, along with the launch of MacBook Neo, which is captivating customers all around the world.? Record results for the January?March quarter for revenue, profit, and iPhone revenue in particular. And iPhones were constrained by supply. Tim Cook led the analyst conference call because he?s still CEO, but John Ternus joined

for the first time. Worth a listen to just their opening remarks. Over at Six Colors, Jason Snell has the usual assortment of graphs charting Apple's numbers. Spoiler: up, up, up. And he has his usual transcript of the analyst call . From that transcript, this bit from Terner's prepared statement made me smile: I want to echo Tim's sentiment ab...

6. ? On the Future of Apple's Vision Platform

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-01T00:11:15Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/04/on_the_future_of_apples_vision_platform

It's certainly possible that this Vision thing isn't going to work out and Apple *will* throw in the towel on it. But that hasn't happened, and if it does, it's not going to come out of nowhere as a story on MacRumors for the people in VPG working on it.

7. I'm Starting to Wonder What They're Smoking Over There at MacRumors

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-04-30T15:16:12Z

Link: <https://www.macrumors.com/2026/04/29/apple-questioning-iphone-magsafe/>

600 words from Hartley Charlton at MacRumors expounding upon a wacko post on Weibo suggesting that Apple is debating dropping MagSafe from all iPhones (which post , translated to English, is only 70-some words). Given that last year's 16e didn't have MagSafe and this year's 17e does, you don't need a pseudonymous Chinese weatherman to know which way the MagSafe wind is blowing in Cupertino. ?

8. Developing a cross-process reader/writer lock with limited readers, part 3: Fairness

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260430-00/?p=112288>

Let the exclusive acquisition have a fair chance against shared acquisitions. The post Developing a cross-process reader/writer lock with limited readers, part 3: Fairness appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Developing a cross-process reader/writer lock with limited readers, part 2: Taking turns when being grabby

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 29 Apr 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260429-00/?p=112286>

Please, not everybody, everything all at once. The post Developing a cross-process reader/writer lock with limited readers, part 2: Taking turns when being grabby appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. You're probably taking the wrong painkiller

Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-04-30T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://dynamight.net/painkillers/>

This is an essay that recently appeared in Asterisk . Consider the rest of the risk issue for all your risk needs. Lots of people die after overdosing on acetaminophen (paracetamol, Tylenol, Panadol). In the U.S., it's estimated to cause 56,000 emergency department visits, 2,600 hospitalizations, and 500 deaths per year. Acetaminophen has a scarily narrow therapeutic window. The instructions on the package say it's okay to take up to four grams per day. If you take eight grams, your liver could fail and you could die. Meanwhile, it seems to be really hard to kill yourself by overdosing on ibuprofen (Advil, Nurofen, Motrin, Brufen). In 2006, Wood et al. searched the medical literature and found 10 documented cases in history. Nine of those cases involved complicating factors, and in the 10th, a woman took the equivalent of more than 500 standard (200mg) pills. So, for many years, if I needed a painkiller, I'd try to take ibuprofen rather than acetaminophen. My logic was that if eight grams of acetaminophen could kill my liver, then one gram was probably still hard on it. I'm fond of my liver and didn't want to cause it any unnecessary inconvenience. But guess what? My logic was wro...

11. Switching entirely to Corfu in my GNU Emacs configuration

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-04-30T02:24:23Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/EmacsSwitchingToOnlyCorfu>

Somewhat recently I read this article on a modular completion framework for GNU Emacs (via) and expressed a thought on the Fediverse : If lsp-mode in GNU Emacs supported corfu in addition to (or instead of) company-mode, I would probably switch from company to corfu just to have a unified completion environment. But I don't think as-you-type completion with LSP is supported in anything except company-mode, and I'm not moving to eglot (I looked once and rejected it). Oh well, maybe someday I can unify things a bit more. (Or I will get annoyed with as-you-type completion.) (I already use corfu for general completion , with company-mode only used in lsp-mode buffers.) I was wrong; corfu does support as you type completion . Corfu calls this auto completion and doesn't enable it by default, but you can change that if you want, either locally to specific buffers or generally. Today I gave things a try and after the dust has settled, I've switched entirely to corfu , even in lsp-mode, with some additional changes. As I discovered when I first explored as you type autocompletion in GNU Emacs , I like seeing the completion information but what I don't want is to have my keystrokes stol...

12. Approximating even functions by powers of cosine

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Fri, 01 May 2026 00:06:12 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/04/30/burmanns-theorem/>

A couple days ago I wrote a post about turning a trick into a technique, finding another use for a clever way to construct simple, accurate approximations. I used as my example approximating the Bessel function $J(x)$ with $(1 + \cos(x))/2$. I learned via a helpful comment on Mathstodon that my approximation was the first-order [?] The post Approximating even functions by powers of cosine first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Three ways to differentiate ReLU

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 14:51:08 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/04/30/derivative-of-relu/>

When a function is not differentiable in the classical sense there are multiple ways to compute a generalized derivative. This post will look at three generalizations of the classical derivative, each applied to the ReLU (rectified linear unit) function. The ReLU function is a commonly used activation function for neural networks. It's also called the [?] The post Three ways to differentiate ReLU first appeared on John D. Cook .

14. Announcing the 2026 Open Source Fantasy Draft

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-04-30T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/04/30/open-source-fantasy-draft.html>

Registration is now open for the sixth season of the Open Source Fantasy League. Twelve teams, snake draft, standard scoring. The board goes live next Tuesday and as commissioner I'm publishing the rule changes and some notes on this year's class before everyone starts arguing in the group chat. For anyone joining fresh: you draft a roster of maintainers, you score points when their packages get downloaded, you lose points when their packages get a CVE, and at the end of the season the winner chooses which charity receives the prize pool we forgot to collect. It's exactly like regular fantasy football except the players don't know they're playing, aren't paid, and can retire mid-season by archiving a repository. Roster slots One BDFL, two Core, two Flex (a Flex can be a maintainer or a bot, so yes, you can still start Dependabot at Flex if you enjoy ninety pull requests and four points a week), one Defence, one Nebraska, four bench. The Nebraska slot is unchanged from last year: it must be filled by a single individual nobody in your household has heard of whose project is a transitive dependency of at least ten thousand other packages. Verification is on the honour system because...

15. Notes from April 2026

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/notes-from-april-2026/>

After a busy March , April was a little quieter. But don't worry, I still have a bunch of

little links for you to click on. Things I published GitHub's uptime hasn't been great recently. Even though I dislike the Microsoft subsidiary, I wrote [In defense of GitHub's poor uptime?](#), which argues that it's not as bad as folks seems to be saying. See this [Lobsters thread](#) for some discussion. Published version 0.2.0 of [setbigtimeout](#), my JavaScript library for waiting a very long time. Like every month, I published a few articles over at [Zelda Dungeon](#). We had a slew of shitposts for April Fool's this year. I think my favorite (not written by me) was [Daily Debate: Do You Think Old Man Was Once Young Man??](#). Links I clicked [Ghost](#), my employer, was recognized as a digital public good. [You can't advertise people out of reacting to their own experiences](#). This is a fundamental disconnect between how tech people with software brains see the world and how regular people are living their lives. [From 'The people do not yearn for automation'](#). I subscribed to the RSS feed for internet RFCs. Most of this is over my head but it's neat! This post argues that [any gains we do realize \[from LLM...](#)

16. How an Oil Refinery Works

Source: [Construction Physics](#) | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 12:03:35 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-an-oil-refinery-works>

Though wind and solar continue to carve out larger and larger shares of world energy supply, the modern world still runs on petroleum, and will continue to do so for the foreseeable future.

17. Pluralistic: How not to ban surveillance pricing (30 Apr 2026)

Source: [Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow](#) | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 14:38:35 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/04/30/something-must-be-done/>

Today's links [How not to ban surveillance pricing](#): Maryland's new consumer protection law is all loophole. Hey look at this: [Delights to delectate](#). [Object permanence](#): Google's 8,000 Linux servers; [Battleshoe](#); [Knitted potholes](#); [Unpack the court](#); ["Robot Artists and Black Swans"](#); [Enshittifying tech jobs](#). Upcoming appearances: Berlin, NYC, Barcelona, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. [How not to ban surveillance pricing \(permalink\)](#) If you want to piss me off, it's easy: just breezily assert that our tech regulation problems are the result of the fast pace of technological change racing ahead of the plodding speed of governmental action: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/04/22/uber-for-nurses/#go-meta> While there have been some instances in which this was true, it is far more often the case that there are blindingly obvious answers to tech problems, which our lawmakers and regulators ignore, amidst a rising chorus of warnings about the dire consequences of failing to act. Take the new Maryland bill that (supposedly) outlaws surveill...

18. Thoughts on WebAssembly as a stack machine

Source: [Eli Bendersky's website](#) | Published: 2026-04-29T19:28:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/thoughts-on-webassembly-as-a-stack-machine/>

This week the article [Wasm is not quite a stack machine](#) has been making the rounds and has caught my eye. The post claims that WASM is not a pure stack machine because it has locals and is missing some stack manipulation operations like `dup` and `swap`. While I don't ?

19. If I Could Make My Own GitHub

Source: [matduggan.com](#) | Published: Thu, 30 Apr 2026 12:02:49 GMT

Link: <https://matduggan.com/if-i-could-make-my-own-github/>

My friend and I have a game where we talk about what we'd do if we were rich. Not rich like 'paid off the mortgage' rich. Rich like a man who owns a submarine he's never been inside. Rich like a man whose third

20. Sadly, You Can't Print Your Own (safe) mRNA Vaccine

Source: [Bert Hubert's writings](#) | Published: Tue, 30 Mar 2021 15:46:36 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/sadly-you-cant-print-your-own-vaccine/>

Brief post, in response to the many many many technical people that propose to print their own mRNA vaccines ?now that the source is out there?. I've spent a lot of time individually explaining why this is unlikely to happen any time soon, and I thought it a good idea to explain it here as well. Mountains of details on how the vaccines are actually produced can be found on this awesome page by Jonas Neubert and Cornelia Scheitz.

21. The Galileo Eccentric Satellite Surprise

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 21 Mar 2021 11:11:31 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/galileos-eccentric-satellites/>

UPDATE: Back in December 2020 when this article was first posted, I noted that some receivers might not be able to deal with the advent of production signals from the eccentric satellites.

This has indeed proved to be a problem for U-blox F9 series receivers in a specific configuration. The application note links to this article (thanks!) and also (correctly) states that the signals from the eccentric satellites do not in fact comply with the Galileo Open Service ICD.

22. Corona Update: Licht aan het einde van de tunnel

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 14 Mar 2021 09:42:08 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/corona-update-maart-2021/>

En toen was het toch weer tijd voor een Corona Update, de eerste sinds november 2020. Doordat er zoveel nieuws is geweest over varianten en vaccins is het zicht een beetje kwijt op waar we nu zijn. En dat is des te vervelender nu de cijfers weer omhoog lijken te gaan. Daarom een samenvatting die eigenlijk heel rooskleurig is, zelfs met de varianten. Dit betekent overigens niet dat de maatregelen al opgeheven kunnen worden!

23. Why are the Artemis II photos on Flickr?

Source: Anil Dash | Published: 2026-04-30T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://anildash.com/2026/04/30/artemis-photos-flickr/>

If you followed along with the recent joyful celebrations of the Artemis cruise around the moon, and took a moment to dive into the photographic archives of the mission, you might have noticed that all of the original images were shared by NASA on the venerable photo sharing service Flickr . What you might not know is? why? Here?s the TL;DR: Flickr comes from (and helped start!) the Web 2.0 era, which was based on users having control over their data Tools at that time began giving creators the power to decide what license they wanted to release their content under, including permissions about how it could be shared, used, or remixed Because the people who made platforms back then were users and creators themselves, they thought about the long term and wanted to be able to preserve people?s work After lots of corporate shuffling, Flickr ended up in the hands of a family-owned company, SmugMug, and they made the Flickr Foundation to preserve public photos for the next 100 years NASA?s images should only be on a service where they can be stored in full resolution, for the long term, dedicated to the public domain ? which the other social media apps of today can?t do The Photographic...